

Chapter 26

Using the Cut Page

The Cut page is a focused environment for fast editing. It's useful in situations where you need to quickly cut a news segment, build an episode of web content, edit a straightforward program, experiment with multiple arrangements of a scene, or put together a first assembly edit.

The Cut page is also a good introductory editing interface for people who are new to editing, as it presents a streamlined set of tools that are fast to learn and simple to use. Whatever your background, you'll find the Cut page to be a valuable addition to your editing experience in DaVinci Resolve.

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Overview of the Cut Page

With the addition of the Cut page, DaVinci Resolve now has two editing environments, intended for two different audiences. While the Cut and Edit pages share many of the same panels such as the Media Pool, the Timeline, and the Viewer, the controls that are exposed on the Cut page have been designed for speed, so you can cut professional programs faster than you've ever been able to before.

Overview of the Cut Page User Interface

The default workspace of the Cut page consists of the Media Pool, a single Viewer, and the Timeline area. These three regions let you quickly import and organize clips, edit clips, and even export the result, all from within the Cut page.



The Cut page interface

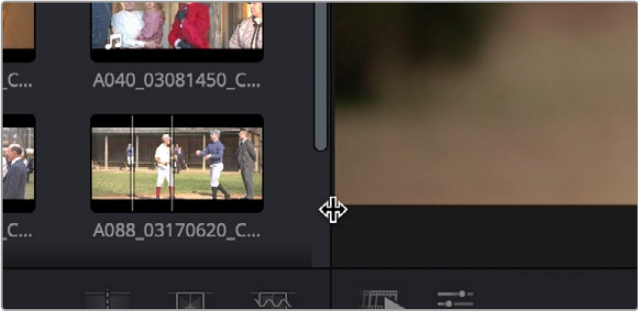
Customizing the UI

A User Interface toolbar at the top of the Cut page lets you hide and show different panels as necessary. For example, you can hide the Media Pool if you wanted more room for the Viewer. You can also replace the Media Pool with other browsers in the Media Pool's default area, showing the Sync Bin, Transitions, Titles, or Effects Browser in order to add those effects to your program in the Timeline. On the right side of the User Interface toolbar you can perform a Quick Export, expand the Viewer to Full Screen, or open the Inspector.

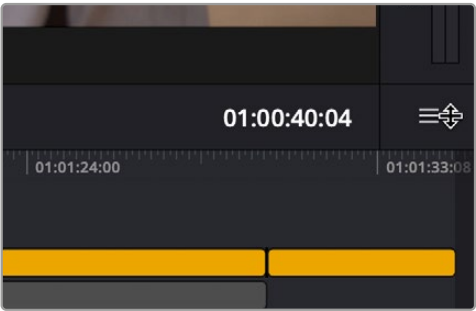


Separate tabs on the left let you open the Media Pool, Sync Bin, Keyframe Editor, Transitions, Titles, and Effects browser.

You can resize the Media Pool and Viewer by dragging the vertical seam that connects them to the left or right, in the process making one panel bigger and the neighboring panel smaller.



The Viewer resize handle



The Timeline resize handle

You can also resize the Timeline area by dragging the timeline handle (at the upper right corner of the Timeline) up or down, making more or less room for the Timeline while simultaneously resizing the Media Pool and Viewer areas.

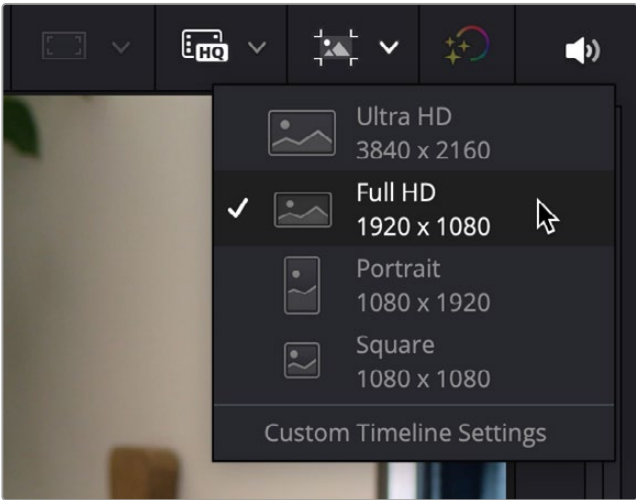
Choose Settings Before You Start

When you first create a new project, you need to define its Timeline settings; you can optionally choose from common presets or a fully custom setup.

Timeline Resolution Quick Menu

This drop-down menu, to the top-right of the Viewer, lets you quickly choose which resolution you want to work at. A Custom option lets you open up the Timeline Settings panel in order to choose your own options.

For more information about the Timeline Settings, see *Chapter 6, "Project Settings."*

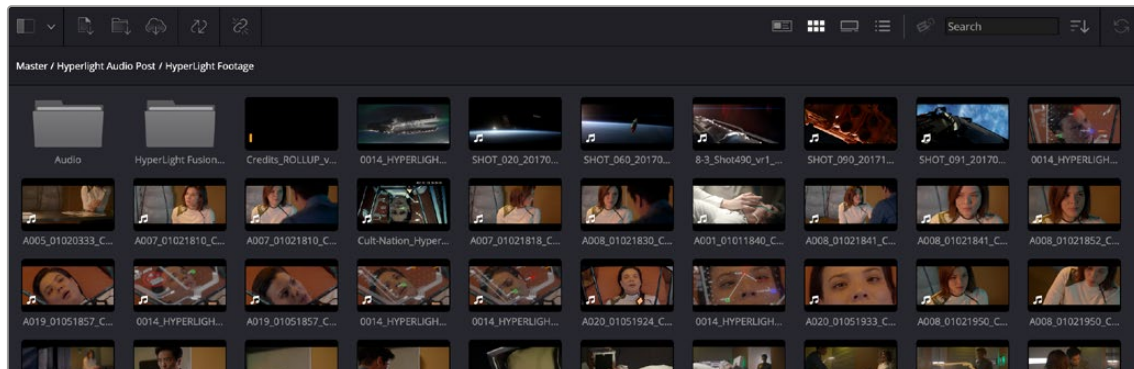


The Project Settings quick menu

The Media Pool

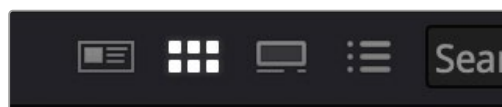
The Media Pool contains all video clips, audio clips, graphics, and other media that you import into your project. You can create bins with which to organize all of this media, to make it easier to find what you need quickly. These bins are opened via the bin drop-down at the upper left-hand corner.

Each piece of media you import, whether it's video, audio, or graphics, appears as an individual clip and can be selected, scrubbed for fast viewing, reorganized into bins, opened into the Viewer for playback, or edited into a timeline using the edit buttons or via drag and drop.

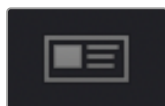


The Media Pool in Thumbnail view

View icons at the upper right of the Media Pool let you see your clips in different ways, depending on what you need to accomplish.



The Viewing ModeFs buttons



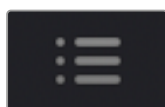
Metadata view: Each clip is represented by its own card with a scrubbable thumbnail and basic clip metadata information visible. This view is designed to have more metadata information than a thumbnail view but more targeted information than the List view.



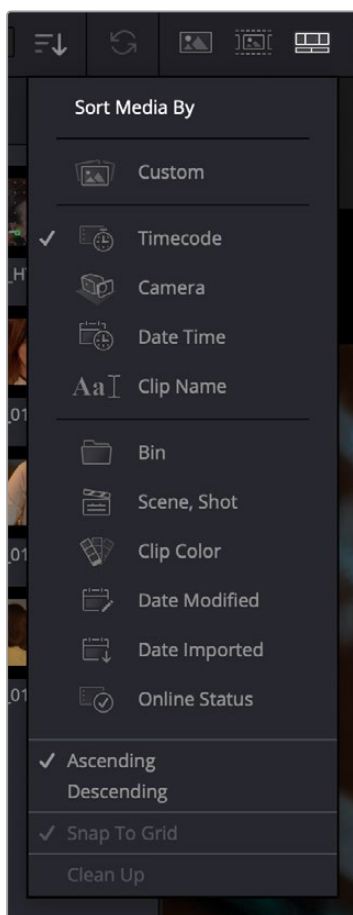
Thumbnail view: Each clip is represented by a scrubbable thumbnail. Hover the playhead over each thumbnail and move it left and right to see the clip's image play, and use the I and O keys to mark sections of a clip that you want to use. Clicking on the lower right corner of a thumbnail reveals the clip's metadata.



Filmstrip view: Each clip is represented by a filmstrip of consecutive frames the length of the Media Pool. Hover the playhead over the clip and move it left and right to see the clip's image play, and use the I and O keys to mark sections of a clip that you want to use.



List view: Each clip appears as an item in a multi-column list showing a variety of metadata about each clip. In List view, you can click the header of any column to sort the contents by that column's information (clicking again toggles the sort order between Ascending and Descending). Scrolling right reveals additional columns of information.



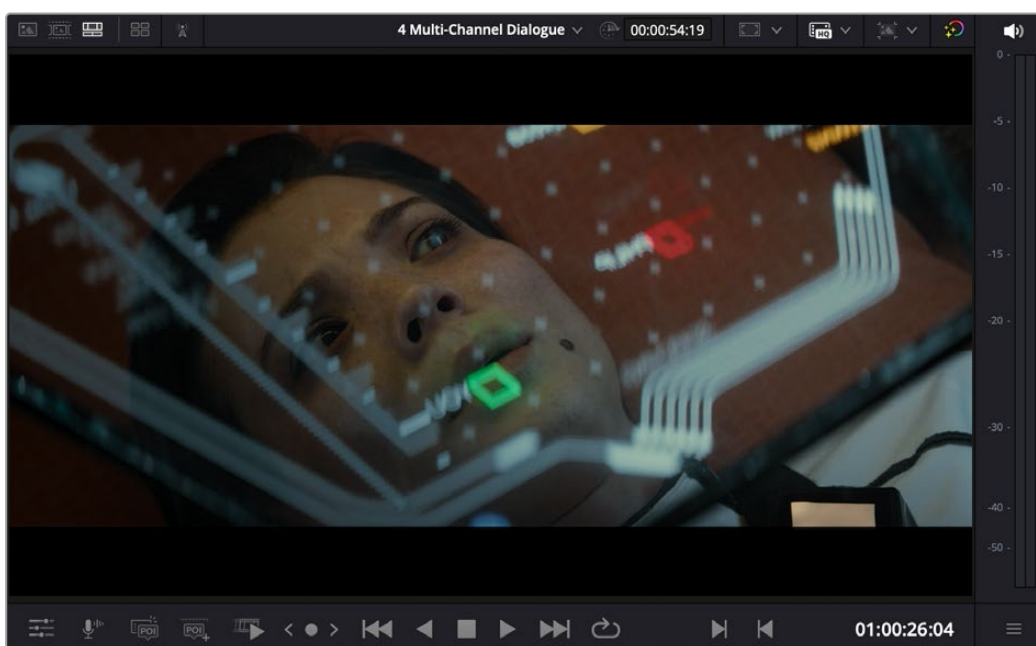
A Sort Media By drop-down menu lets you choose which criteria defines the order in which clips in the Media Pool are arranged. Options include: Custom, Timecode, Camera, Date Time, Clip Name, Bin, Scene Shot, Clip Color, Date Modified, Date Imported, and Online Status. You can choose to sort in Ascending (bottom to top) or Descending (top to bottom) order.

Lastly, a search field lets you type a term you want to use to find one or more clips that match that criteria. When you type anything, the contents of the Media Pool shrink to show only clips that match your criteria.

The Sort Media By dropdown menu

The Viewer

The Viewer lets you see clips from the Media Pool, or clips in the Timeline, and has numerous controls to control what you see and how things play.



The single Viewer in the Cut page

The Viewer has four mode options. Which option is currently in use can be seen, and switched, by four buttons in the upper lefthand corner of the Viewer.



The Viewer modes buttons

The Different options are entered automatically by various actions (from left to right):

- You can double-click any clip to open it into the Viewer as a Source Clip.
- You can view an entire bin full of clips in the Source Tape.
- You can play your edited program in the Timeline.
- You can see all of your synced material at the same time in the Multi Source viewer.

Playing Clips and Navigating the Timeline

Several controls sit at the bottom of the Viewer. These let you play through and otherwise navigate clips and the Timeline in different ways. These controls are described from left to right.



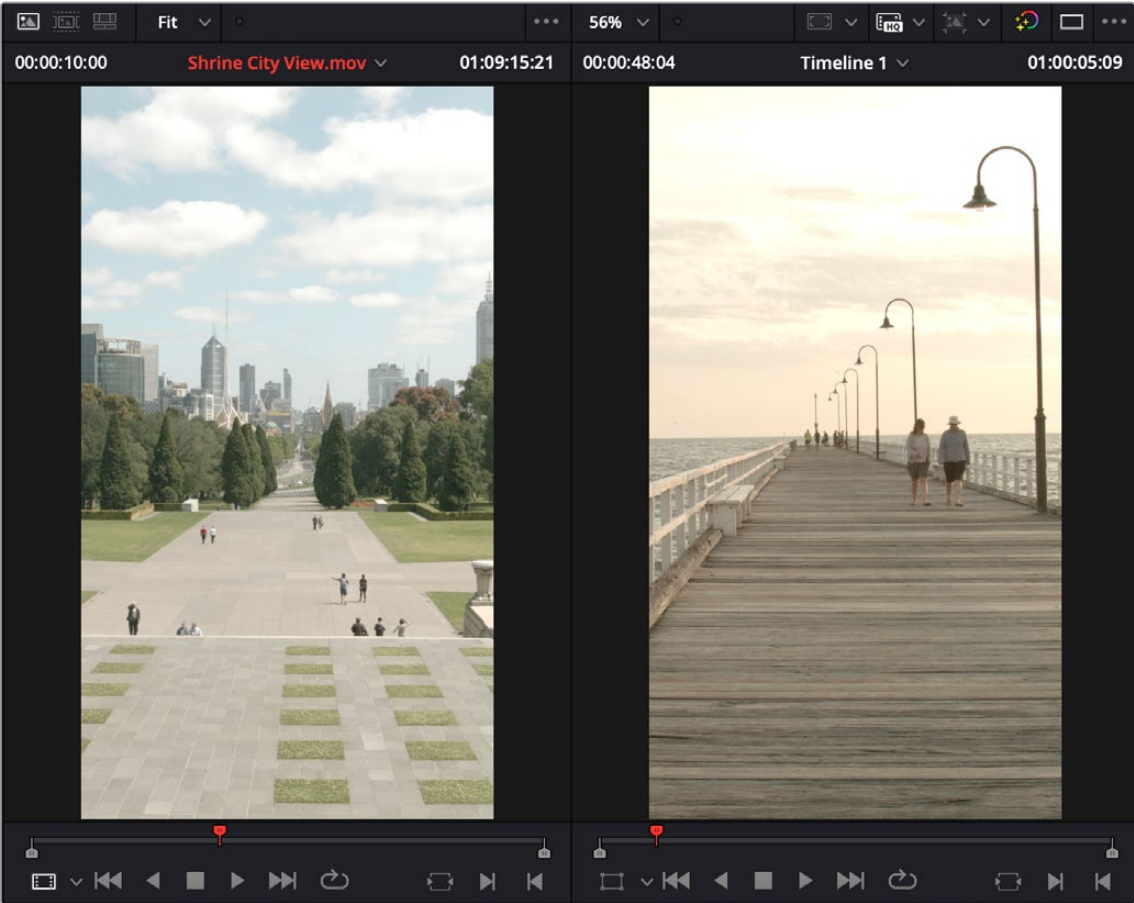
The toolbar at the bottom of the Viewer

- **Tools button:** The Tools button reveals a variety of controls for transform, crop, audio, speed effects, camera stabilization and lens correction, dynamic zoom, and compositing, covered in more detail later in this chapter.
- **Voiceover:** Reveals controls for recording voice over directly into the timeline.
- **POI and Add POI:** These tools are used for selecting and modifying Points of Interest in Replay, which is described in its own manual. For more information on these tools, see the “DaVinci Resolve Replay Editor Instruction Manual.”
- **Fast Review button:** Intended to help you watch through a large collection of media quickly, clicking this button begins accelerated playback through the Source Tape or through the Timeline, where the speed of playback is relative to the length of each clip you’re playing through. Long clips play faster, whereas shorter clips play closer to real time. In this way, you can watch a lot of material really quickly.
- **Jog control:** Clicking and dragging within the jog control lets you scrub very precisely through the content of the Viewer.
- **Transport controls:** A set of Previous Edit (Up Arrow), Stop (Spacebar), Play (Spacebar), Next Edit (Down Arrow), and Loop Playback (Command-/) buttons constitute clickable controls for controlling playback of clips and the Timeline. Each button has a matching keyboard shortcut.
- **Mark In/Out:** Clickable controls to set In and Out points respectively.
- **Playhead timecode:** A number field shows you the timecode value at the playhead of a clip or of the Timeline to give you a numeric reference for where you are.

Optimized UI Layouts for Vertical Editing

Optimized layouts for vertical timelines and projects are supported in DaVinci Resolve. When a vertical timeline or project is loaded, the UI automatically switches to a layout optimized for vertical viewers on the Cut, Edit, and Color pages. Loading a normal landscape timeline or project then automatically switches back to the original layout. No additional user intervention is needed.

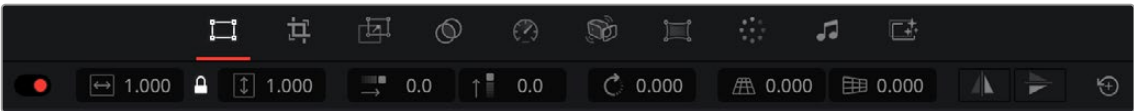
You can change this behavior in Preferences > User > UI Settings > Use optimized UI layouts for vertical video. Unchecking this box retains the normal horizontal layout, even for vertical video timelines.



The UI now changes format to accommodate vertical video timelines automatically.

Tools

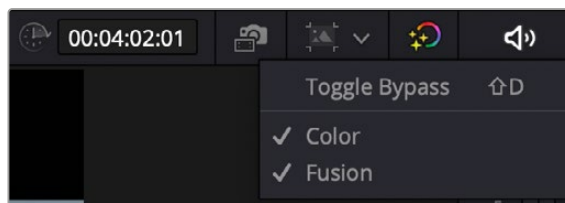
Clicking the Tools button reveals a toolbar that you can use to add and edit clip effects, right within the Viewer with no Inspector needed. The Tools button reveals a variety of controls for transform, crop, audio, speed effects, camera stabilization and lens correction, dynamic zoom, and compositing, covered in more detail later in this chapter.



The Tools bar shown opened to the transform controls.

Bypass Color Grades and Fusion

The Bypass Color Grades and Fusion Effects button/drop-down lets you turn off all grades and effects that you may have applied in the Color page and/or Fusion page in order to improve playback performance on low power computers. Click the button (Shift-D) to disable or reenable grading and effects, or right-click this button to access a menu that lets you choose which things you want this button to control.



The Bypass Grades and Fusion button, shown being right-clicked to view its options

Export The Current Frame from The Viewer

You can now export a still frame from the Viewer in the Media, Cut, and Edit pages.

To Export a Still Frame from the Viewer:

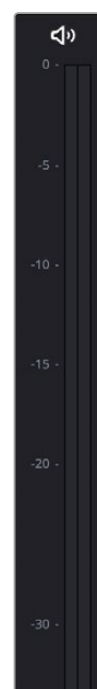
- 1 Use the Viewer's playback controls to navigate to the frame you want to export.
- 2 Select File > Export > Current Frame as Still.
- 3 Enter the name of the still frame in the File System viewer.
- 4 Enter the desired format of the still frame in the File System viewer.
- 5 Click on the Export button.

Audio Meter

An audio meter to the right of the Viewer shows you a graphical representation of the audio levels playing in the current clip or in the Timeline as you play through the Viewer, via animated vertical bars that are tinted to indicate how loud the levels are:

- Green indicates safe levels
- Yellow indicates levels that are peaking at approximately safe levels
- Red indicates levels that may be peaking at levels that are too high, risking clipping the signal and causing distortion

These animated bars serve as a visual reference you can use to help you adjust the volume of different clips to create a pleasing balance, and to make sure you don't exceed the maximum desired level and introduce clipping. A speaker button at the top of the meters lets you mute or unmute audio playback.



The Audio Meter showing an audio signal

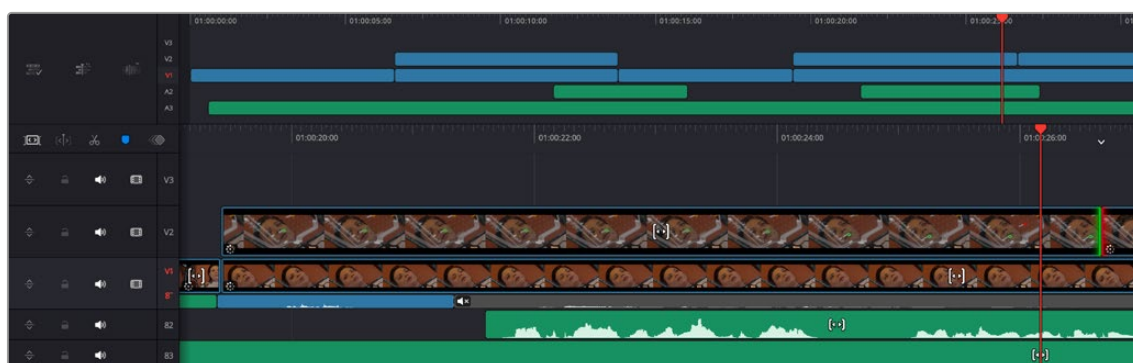
The Timeline

The word “timeline” refers both to an edited sequence of clips, which constitutes a program that is stored in the Media Pool, and to the area of the Cut page interface where you can open this sequence of clips to see its contents, and for playback and editing.

Timelines are created and stored in the Media Pool, along with all of your other clips. However, each timeline is assembled and edited in what is sometimes referred to as the Timeline Editor. Different pages of DaVinci Resolve show your timeline differently according to the special requirements of each page focusing variously on different methods of editing, grading, compositing, and audio.

However, while the interface of the Timeline Editor changes from page to page, the actual contents of the Timeline are identical, because each page’s Timeline Editor is in fact showing the exact same Timeline that is currently open. This means that the advanced user can use every page of DaVinci to do different things to the same Timeline, with only the interface changing to make different functions possible in different pages.

For the Cut page user, the Timeline is divided into an Upper Timeline at the top, and a larger and more detailed Timeline Editor showing a zoomed in portion of the Timeline around the playhead at the bottom. Working together, these two views of your edited sequence make it possible to navigate your entire project and cut in great detail.



The Timeline of the Cut page, comprising the Upper Timeline and the zoomed in Lower Timeline

Upper Timeline

The Upper Timeline always shows the entire program within the full width of your computer’s display. The Upper Timeline’s playhead is always free, which makes it easy to use your pointer to scroll around the entire program by dragging within the Timeline Ruler at top. This also serves as a visual reference for keeping track of where you are in your program while you’re editing within the zoomed-in Lower Timeline below.

Despite the Upper Timeline’s relatively small size, you can still edit in it, with most editing and trimming functions that are available in the Lower Timeline also available in the Upper Timeline. Most interestingly, it’s also possible to drag clips from one part of your program in the Lower Timeline, to another area of your program in the Upper Timeline, and vice versa. Right-clicking on a clip in the Upper Timeline will open the same context menu as right-clicking on a clip in the Cut page’s main timeline, allowing you to perform the same operations.

A set of small numbers to the left of the Upper Timeline lets you click a number to choose the currently selected track; this selection is mirrored on the zoomed in timeline below. The currently selected track affects where incoming clips will be placed when editing, among other things.

Lower Timeline

The zoomed in Lower Timeline (often referred to simply as “the Timeline”) shows you a close-up view of the portion of the currently open timeline that immediately surrounds the playhead. The zoom level is fixed; you cannot change it. The zoomed-in lower timeline is intended for detailed editing, but clips can be dragged between the Timeline and Upper Timeline for fast reordering of clips across the entire duration of your program.

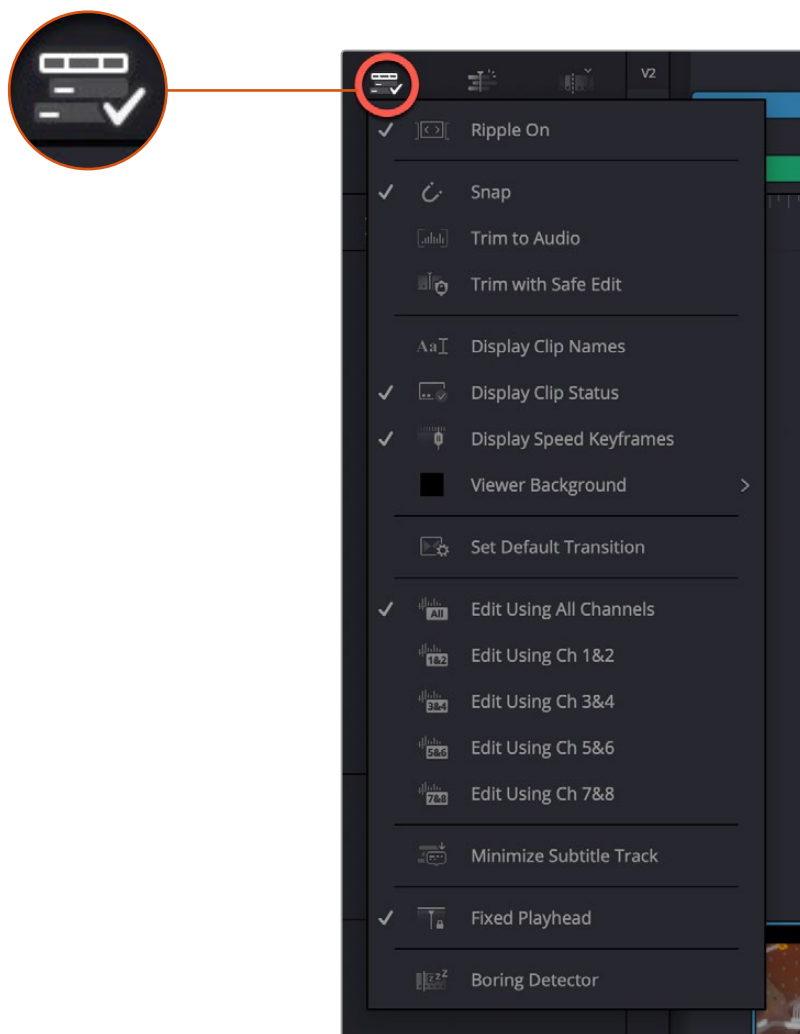
The Toolbar contains several editing functions grouped together in Action and Option menus. These functions are accessed by clicking on the appropriate icon and selecting a function from the drop-down menu. These tools are discussed in detail throughout the Cut section of the manual.



The Toolbar icons (from left to right):
Timeline Options, Timeline Actions, Edit Actions

Timeline Options

The tools under this icon deal with how the clips and timeline are displayed, and certain modes and tools that apply to the whole timeline.

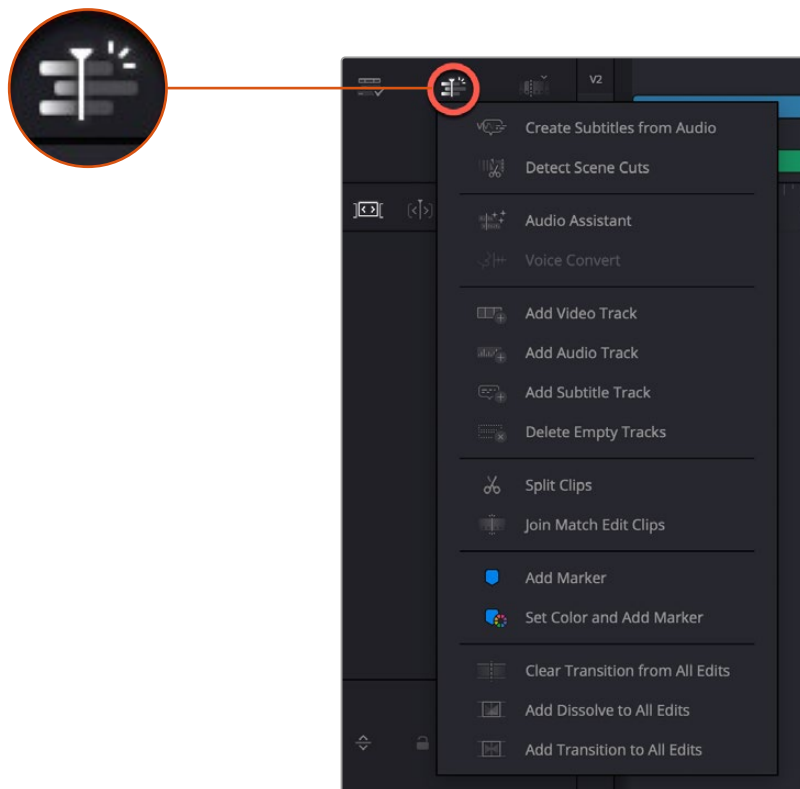


All of the Timeline Options functions

- **Ripple On:** Toggles ripple editing behavior on track V1.
- **Snap:** Toggles the playhead snapping behavior on or off.
- **Trim to Audio:** Opens an expanded audio view on the timeline when trimming a clip.
- **Trim with Safe Edit:** Toggles the Safe Edit function to prevent you from accidentally overwriting adjacent clips while trimming.
- **Display Clip Names:** Toggles displaying the clip name on the timeline clip.
- **Display Clip Status:** Toggles displaying the status icons of various operations on the timeline clip.
- **Display Speed Keyframes:** Toggles displaying the Speed Keyframes on a clip with speed changes applied.
- **Viewer Background:** Lets you choose how the blank areas of the Viewer background are displayed, either Checkerboard, Black, Gray, or Alert Red.
- **Set Default Transition:** Opens the Set Default Transition window, letting you choose the transition type, duration, and alignment for the default transition.
- **Edit Using (Audio Track):** Lets you choose either All audio tracks or select specific audio pairs to edit with on the Cut page.
- **Minimize Subtitle Track:** Shrinks the vertical size of the subtitle tracks to give you more room in the timeline.
- **Fixed Playhead:** Toggles the fixed playhead on or off. On leaves the playhead in place while the timeline passes underneath it, while off makes the playhead move along the timeline.
- **Boring Detector:** Activates the Boring Detector.

Timeline Actions

The tools under this icon are generally used to add new items or make modifications to the Timeline.

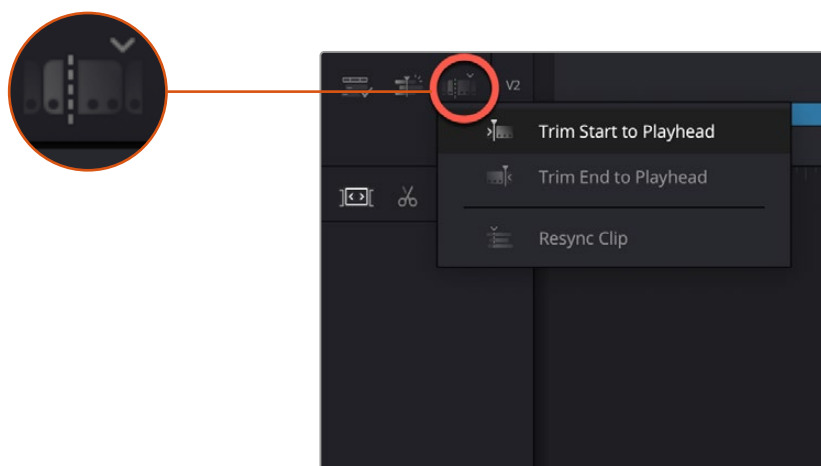


All of the Timeline Actions functions

- **Create Subtitles from Audio:** Automatically creates subtitles for all dialog in the timeline.
- **Detect Scene Cuts:** Performs a Detect Scene Cuts operation, splitting one long clip of a finished program into individual clips again.
- **Audio Assistant:** Uses AI to automatically perform an audio mix of your timeline based on common deliverable requirements.
- **Voice Convert:** Uses AI to let you change the speaking voice from one person to another.
- **Add Video Track:** Adds a video track to the timeline.
- **Add Audio Track:** Adds an audio track to the timeline.
- **Add Subtitle Track:** Adds a Subtitle Track to the timeline.
- **Split Clips:** Splits the current clip in two at the playhead position.
- **Join Match Edit Clips:** Rejoins two continuous clips that have been split.
- **Add Marker:** Adds a marker at the playhead position.
- **Set Color and Add Marker:** Adds a marker and opens the Markers editor, so you can change the color and add comments, etc.
- **Clear Transition from All Edits:** Removes all existing transitions from the timeline.
- **Add Dissolve to All Edits:** Adds a Cross Dissolve to every edit point on the timeline.
- **Add Transition to All Edits:** Adds the last used transition to every edit point on the timeline.

Edit Actions

The tools under this icon are used to adjust clips on the Timeline.

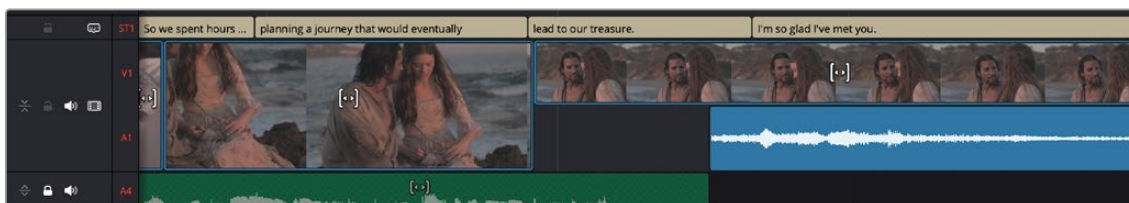


All of the Edit Actions functions

- **Trim Start to Playhead:** Deletes everything of the clip to the left of the playhead.
- **Trim End to Playhead:** Deletes everything of the clip to the right of the playhead.
- **Resync Clip:** If a clip has slipped sync from the rest of the program, this operation will resync it.

Tracks

The Timeline is divided into multiple tracks, with each track capable of holding a sequence of clips in order to create a program. The main tracks, which are labeled numerically, combine a clip's video and audio into a single item in the Timeline, for simplicity. Editing the In or Out point of a clip edits the video and audio together.

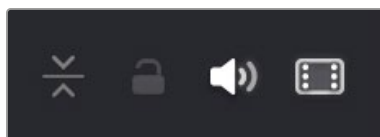


Cut Page Timeline tracks. Track ST1 shows a subtitle track. Track V1 shows both Video only and combined Video+Audio clips in an enlarged view. Track A4 shows a separate audio track.

TIP: In the Edit page, Video+Audio clips are presented as separated Video and Audio items on different tracks. When you open the Fairlight page, audio is presented on tracks with lanes, where each audio channel can be seen. In this way, each page gives you different sets of controls over the contents of the Timeline that are appropriate for each page.

Track Header Controls

The track controls, in order, allow you to enlarge a track, lock the track for edits, mute audio, and enable or disable video for the track.



Controls to enlarge, lock, mute audio, and disable video for the track

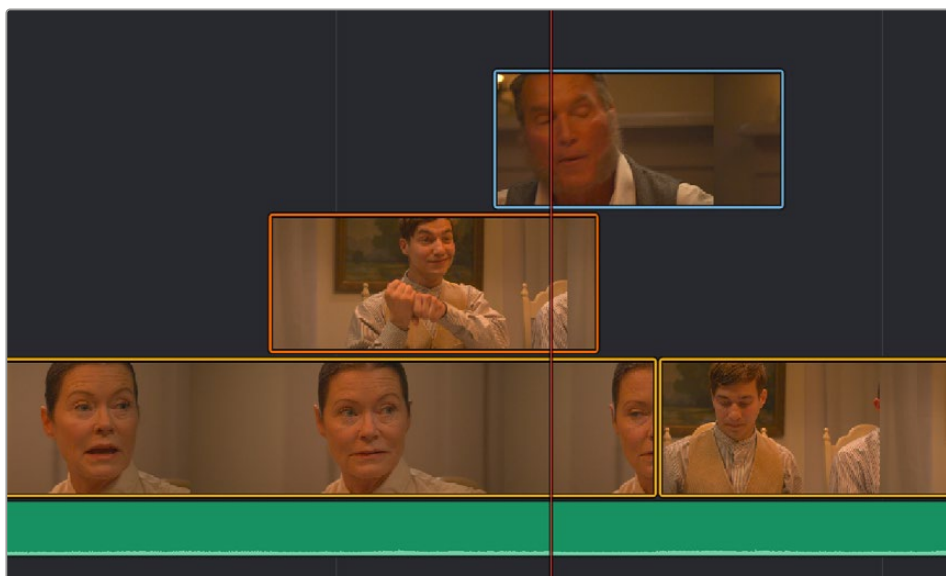
The Importance of Track 1

Each track in the Timeline of the Cut page is designed to carry specific parts of your program. Track 1 is intended for the primary video+audio of your program, often called the “A-roll,” since these are the primary shots comprising the timing and pacing of the story you’re telling. Adding, deleting, inserting, trimming, or otherwise rearranging clips on Track 1 results in the rest of the edited timeline being automatically rippled to accommodate the change you’ve made, with clips to the right of the changed area moving left to fill the gap of a deleted or shortened clips, or moving right to make room for an inserted or lengthened clip.

Tracks 2 and Above

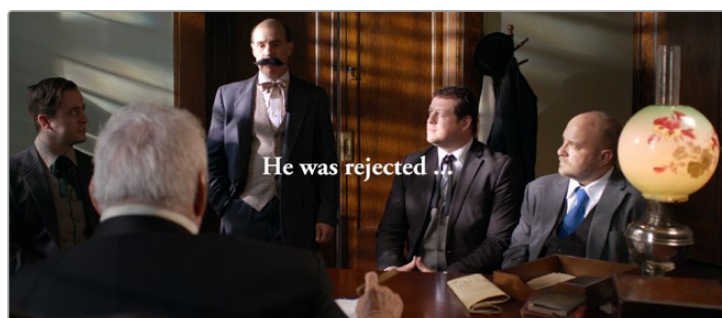
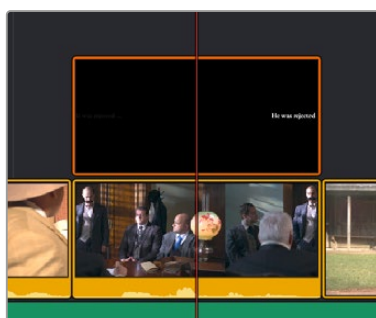
Tracks 2 and above are intended for “B-roll,” which is additional footage you stack on top of other clips in Track 1 to illustrate what someone is saying in the audio of Track 1, or for superimpositions used for compositing effects that combine two images together in creative ways. Moving or resizing clips on Track 2 and above only moves or resizes that one clip; other clips in the Timeline are not rearranged and the Timeline is not rippled when you do this.

For instances where multiple video clips overlap one another on multiple tracks, the video clip on the highest track obscures those on lower tracks, meaning that only the top clips appear during playback. This is useful when you’re experimenting with rearranging multiple clips in a complex scene. For example, you could be editing a scene where an interview clip is on the bottom track, and various b-roll clips are edited on tracks above the interview so you can freely rearrange them in different ways, while it’s always easy to reveal the speaker on the bottom track by leaving a gap in the superimposed b-roll clips.



Editing a scene with multiple superimposed clips

However, if you superimpose video-only or video+audio clips for compositing, you can use the composite modes and the opacity slider found in the Composite section of the Viewer Tools controls to mix multiple images together in different ways for artistic effects.



(Left) Superimposing clips you want to composite, (Right) Creating compositing effects with multiple superimposed clips

You can add additional Video+Audio tracks, when necessary, by either dragging a clip to the undefined gray area of the Timeline above the other existing tracks to make a new track automatically, by clicking the New Track button at the upper lefthand corner of the Timeline, or by right-clicking in the timeline header area and choosing “Add Video Track” from the contextual menu.

Audio-Only Tracks

You can also edit audio-only clips such as music, narration, or sound effects, onto separate audio-only tracks underneath, which are then labeled A1, A2, A3, etcetera. If you drag an audio clip to the undefined gray area of the Timeline below the other existing tracks, an audio-only track will automatically be created.



Audio-only tracks in the Cut page Timeline

Gaps

Because Track 1 is meant to hold the principal clips for your program, the Timeline automatically ripples itself to close gaps that would otherwise result when you move or rearrange clips in Track 1, and superimposed clips in Tracks 2 and above move to keep in sync with the clips they're superimposed over. However, you can move superimposed clips on Tracks 2 and above to place them wherever you want, and gaps will be left between multiple clips on the same superimposed track so they can be edited at specific places.

Timeline Controls

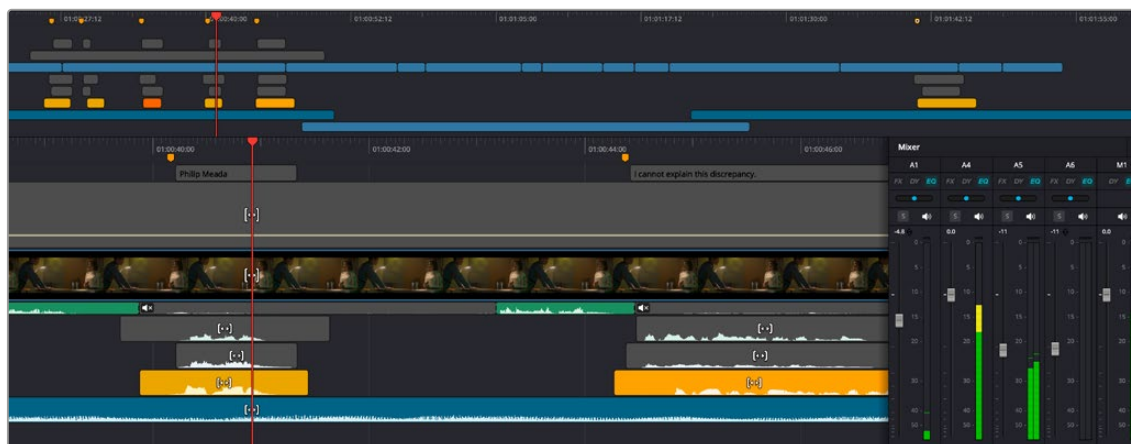
The Timeline controls in the upper left-hand corner of the Timeline let you enable/disable Rippling on Track 1, enter Dynamic Trim mode, Split a clip at the playhead position, create Markers, and open the Keyframe Editor.



The Cut page Timeline controls

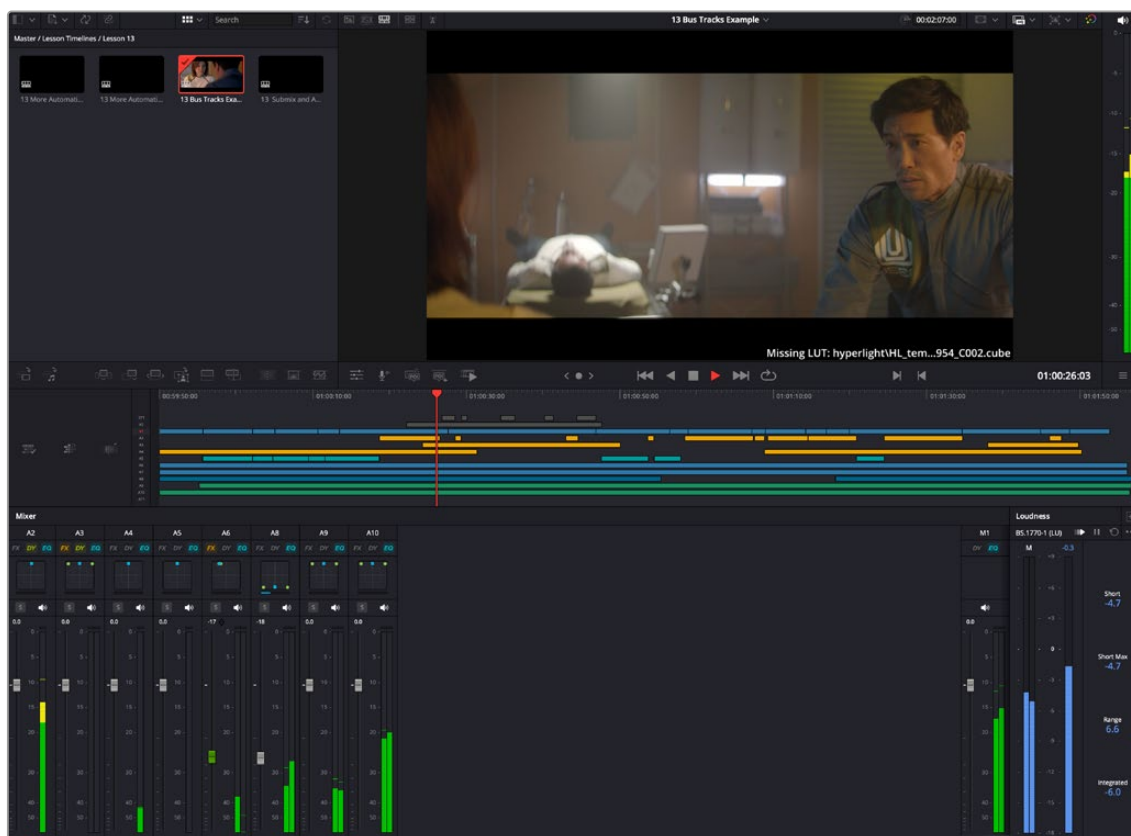
Audio Mixer

The Cut page can show a full Audio Mixer, with access to all the tracks and busses of your mix, in addition to shortcuts to any audio Track FX, Dynamics, and Equalizer tools. To enable the Audio Mixer, select the Mixer tab at the top of the Cut page.



The Audio Mixer in action during Cut page playback

A unique feature of the Cut page Audio Mixer is the ability to expand it fully using the Expand icon in the upper right of the Mixer. This will replace the whole lower timeline with the Mixer, giving you plenty of room to monitor complex audio compositions, while still being able to access the editing functions of the Upper Timeline.



The Audio Mixer expanded, allowing you to see all audio tracks while still editing in the Upper Timeline of the Cut page.

Audio Mixer Controls

Each track's channel strip has the following controls:

- **Track Number:** The number of the timeline audio track corresponding to each channel strip appears here.
- **Track Effects:** Double-click on one of the track effects at the top of the fader controls to open.
 - FX:** Opens the Track Effects controls in the Inspector.
 - EQ:** Opens the Track Equalizer.
 - DY:** Opens the Track Dynamics.
- **Pan control:** Lets you pan a Mono track's audio from left to right, or invert a Stereo track's left and right audio channels, or do surround mixing.
- **Name:** The name of the audio track that channel strip corresponds to. If you've edited the audio track names in the Timeline, those names will appear here.
- **Solo:** Mutes all tracks other than ones that are soloed.
- **Mute:** Disables that audio track.
- **dB:** Shows you the volume, in decibels, that track is currently set to.
- **Fader:** Each track's vertical fader can be dragged with your mouse or other pointing device to adjust the volume of that track and perform automation recording. Dragging up increases volume, dragging down decreases volume.
- **Audio meters:** Audio meters to the right of each fader display the audio volume of all channels on that track during playback. Each channel strip has individual meters corresponding to the number of channels that track has been set to accommodate.

Mute and Solo Tracks For Output

When you use the Mute or Solo controls of the Audio Mixer, track audio is disabled, both during playback and delivery for output. Make sure you have re-enabled any tracks you need before heading to the Deliver page. You can only modify mute and solo tracks on the Edit, Cut, and Fairlight pages.

Replay

The Cut page allows live multi-camera broadcast editing, playout, and replay with speed control.

Some of the Replay features are only available with Blackmagic Design hardware, such as a desktop video interface, cloud store and ATEM switcher.

Please see the dedicated DaVinci Resolve Replay Editor Instruction Manual for more information.



The Cut page Timeline controls

Undo and Redo in DaVinci Resolve

No matter where you are in DaVinci Resolve, Undo and Redo commands let you back out of steps you've taken or commands you've executed, and reapply them if you change your mind. DaVinci Resolve is capable of undoing the entire history of things you've done since creating or opening a particular project. When you close a project, its entire undo history is purged. The next time you begin work on a project, its undo history starts anew.

Because DaVinci Resolve integrates so much functionality in one application, there are three separate sets of undo “stacks” to help you manage your work.

- The Media, Edit and Fairlight pages share the same multiple-undo stack, which lets you backtrack out of changes made in the Media Pool, the Timeline, the Metadata Editor, and the Viewers.
- Each clip in the Fusion page has its own undo stack, so you can undo changes you make to the composition of each clip, independently.
- Each clip in the Color page has its own undo stack, so you can undo changes you make to grades in each clip, independently.

In all cases, there is no practical limit to the number of steps that are undoable (although there may be a limit to what you can remember). To take advantage of this, there are three ways you can undo work to go to a previous state of your project, no matter what page you’re in.

To simply undo or redo changes you’ve made one at a time:

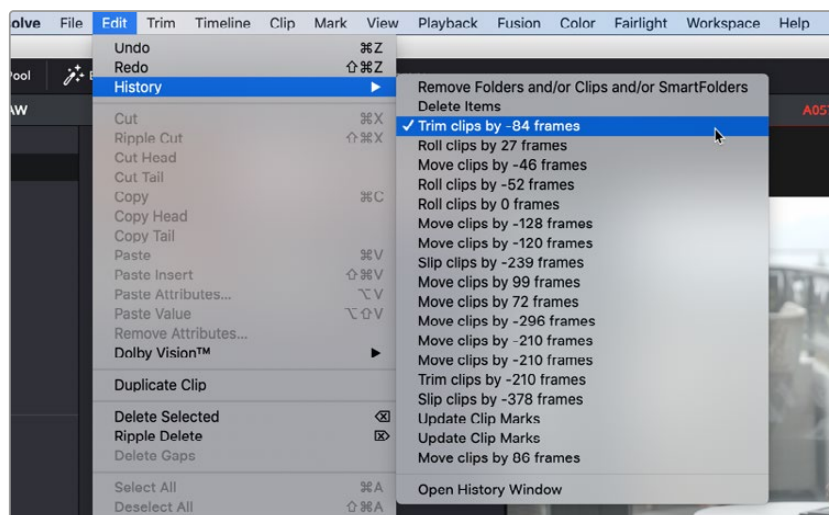
Choose Edit > Undo (Command-Z) to undo the previous change.

Choose Edit > Redo (Shift-Command-Z) to redo to the next change.

You can also undo several steps at a time using the History submenu and window. At the time of this writing, this only works for multiple undo steps in the Media, Cut, Edit, and Fairlight pages.

To undo and redo using the History submenu:

- 1 Open the Edit > History submenu, which shows (up to) the last twenty things you’ve done.
- 2 Choose an item on the list to undo back to that point. The most recent thing you’ve done appears at the top of this list, and the change you’ve just made appears with a check next to it. Steps that have been undone but that can still be redone remain in this menu, so you can see what’s possible. However, if you’ve undone several changes at once and then you make a new change, you cannot undo any more and those steps disappear from the menu.

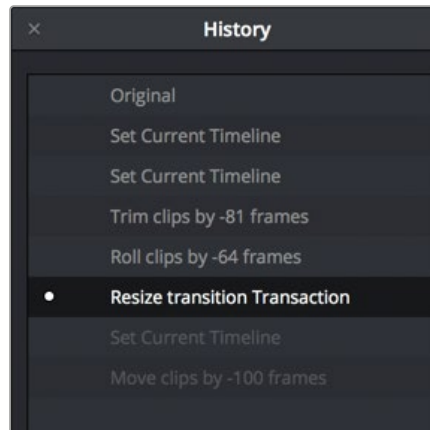


The History submenu, which lets you undo several steps at once

Once you’ve selected a step to undo to, the menu closes and the project updates to show you its current state.

To undo and redo using the History window:

- 1 Choose Edit > History > Open History Window.
- 2 When the History dialog appears, click an item on the list to undo back to that point. Unlike the menu, in this window the most recent thing you've done appears at the bottom of this list. Selecting a change here grays out changes that can still be redone, as the project updates to show you its current state.



The Undo history window that lets you browse the entire available undo stack of the current page

- 3 When you're done, close the History window.